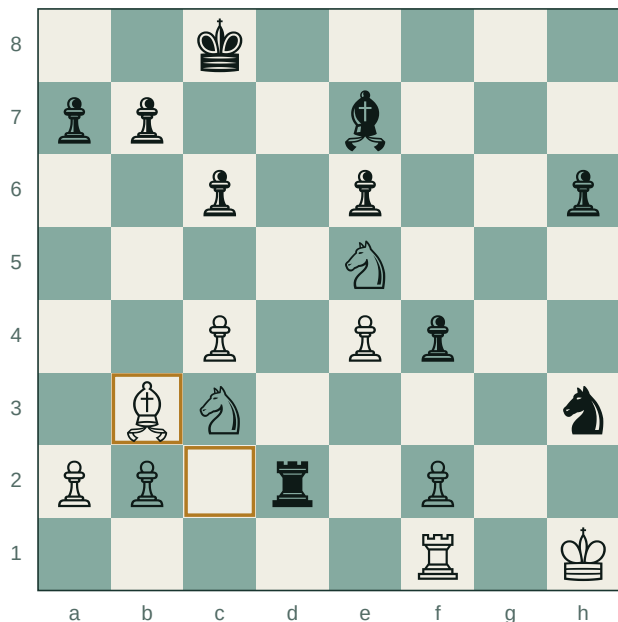


Kingside attacks: Black, move 27

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Bb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Nxf2+ 28. Rxf2 Rxf2

27...Nxf2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f2. Recorded reply: **28.Rxf2**.

28...Rxf2 The rook captures the rook on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: knight on e5 and rook on f1. Check for tactical protection.